

HESA 2023-2024

FAQs

XD HESA

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Document Control

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1.1. Releases and Timelines

What's included in the HESA 2023/24 Release and when will it be released?

Please refer to the [PeopleXD People Management: HESA 2023/24 Release Notes](#) for full details of the release.

Will the release move forward the HESA year?

Yes. The release will roll the year forward within your HESA module to reflect the current year 2023/24, this will by default copy your previous year's configuration e.g. mappings and rules.

1.2. Additional Assistance

I need additional assistance from Access. How can I request this?

If you encounter an issue applying the 2023/24 changes or generating your HESA return, please raise a Support case via the Customer Success Portal and one of the team will be happy to help you.

If your organisation needs HESA training or consultancy (e.g. require a custom SQL rule), please raise an Optimisation Services (OS) case via the Customer Success Portal. This is a chargeable service.

1.3. Rolling forward the HESA year to 2023/24

Do I need to copy the configuration for the new year and roll forward the HESA year?

No. This will happen automatically as part of the release. However, if you need to move into 2023/24 in advance of the release then you can do so. Please refer to the [HESA User Guide](#) for instructions on how to do this.

We have already moved the HESA year forward to 2023/24. Will this cause an issue for the release?

No. The release will recognise that the year has already been rolled forward, and will not attempt to roll it forward again.

1.4. HESA Field label/description changes

The 2023/24 HESA Staff Collection specification changes outline changes to HESA reference data descriptions. For example, the Person. Ethnic label for code 102 has been updated from 'Asian – Filipino' to 'Asian – Filipino or Filipino British'. How do I update these labels?

For each label change mandated by HESA, each HE Provider will need to:

1. Update the label within the PeopleXD HESA module. See [Update reference data descriptions](#) for HESA fields for further details.
2. If applicable, review the corresponding (capture) field within PeopleXD People Management, and the People Management > HESA mapping logic to understand if any further updates are needed.

1.5. Adopting the SOC2020 coding structure (Standard Occupational Classification)

Do I need to do anything to adopt SOC2020 coding structure?

Yes. The PeopleXD 2023/24 HESA release will not update any SOC reference data or contract data within PeopleXD People Management.

Each HE Provider will need to:

- Review how the SOC information is currently handled (i.e. captured in People Management & mapped to HESA, or captured outside of PeopleXD and uploaded directly to the PeopleXD HESA Contract record, or a mixture of both).
- Identify what needs to change to adopt the SOC2020 coding structure.
 - Review whether it's suitable to repurpose the current capture process including updating the reference data against the existing PeopleXD SOC field, or whether a new process is required. If you use a HESA UDF, then the new field will need to be linked/populated.
 - Review how updates to contracts will be managed.
 - Review whether any SQL rules (used to populate other fields) directly reference the old ACTSOC fields.
- If applicable, ensure that PeopleXD data is mapped to the new *HESA.Activity.ACTSOC2020* field appropriately.

Note: The ACTSOC2020 reference data is similar, but different to the old ACTSOC reference data. Additional codes have been added, some codes have been repurposed (i.e. the previous codes have new meanings), and some occupations have been reclassified.

When I look in PeopleXD HESA I don't see a single field called ACTSOC, I see multiple fields called ACTSOC1, ACTSOC2, ACTSOC3 etc. Why is this?

This is because SOC codes are assigned at the Activity level, and a single contract can have one or many Activities. PeopleXD uses separate fields to capture the SOC info per Activity. *ACTSOC1* is the SOC value for Activity 1, *ACTSOC2* is the SOC value for Activity 2, and so on.

The naming convention for the new ACTSOC2020 field will be *ACTSOC20201*, *ACTSOC20202*, *ACTSOC20203* etc.

Note: These fields are always returned to HESA as ACTSOC (or ACTSOC2020 going forward) i.e. they are labelled as ACTSOC/ACTSOC2020 within the applicable Activity structure of the XML file.

My organisation already captures SOC information against the employee contract in PeopleXD People Management using standard UDFs (not HESA UDFs), and we intend to use the same field(s) for the 2023/24 return. Do I need to do anything?

Yes. You will need to do the following:

1. Update the reference data (list items) for each of your SOC UDFs to match the [new coding](#).
2. Determine which contracts need to be updated (i.e. where the contract's current SOC value has been invalidated by changing the reference data, or is no longer correct due to the changes to SOC coding) and update each contract accordingly. It is currently not possible to bulk upload UDF contract amendments.
3. Review the People Management > HESA mapping logic. Assuming you use an SQL Rule to map the UDF to the ACTSOC fields, then the release will automatically update the rule to reference the new fields (e.g. ACTSOC1 updated to ACTSOC20201). Please validate that your rules are working as expected post release.



Note: Please be aware that reference data (list items) for UDF fields are held as free text – and not in a code and description structure. This has the following implications when amending UDF reference data:

- Changes to the UDF reference data (list items) won't cascade down to employee contracts (i.e. will not automatically update values held against the employee contract).
- Changing the text of a list item which has been previously assigned to an employee contract will effectively invalidate the value held against the contract (i.e. the contract value is no longer a valid list item for the field). You may continue to see the invalid value against the contract, but you cannot rely on it as another contract change may clear it out. For example, if an admin or an employee changed another field in the UDF, this will remove the invalid option against the SOC field – leaving the SOC field blank.

Therefore, to maintain the integrity of the SOC data, you must ensure that all SOC values held against employee contracts are updated to valid list items.

Example: Where the SOC text value held against an employee contract is:

- *231 Teaching and Educational Professionals* (where this is a text string and not a code with a separate description)

The SOC UDF reference data (list items) is updated as follows to reflect the SOC2020 coding structure:

- Existing value updated: *231 Teaching and Educational Professionals* changed to *231 Teaching Professionals*.
- New option added: *232 Other Educational Professionals*.

The value held against the employee contract may continue to be:

- *231 Teaching and Educational Professionals*.

However, this is no longer a valid list item for the field so will be blanked out the next time the field is validated (for example, by someone making a change to the contract).

This means that any contract previously classified as *231 Teaching and Educational Professionals* will need to be updated to either:

- *231 Teaching Professionals*; or
- *232 Other Educational Professionals*.

For further information on UDFs, see [PeopleXD People Management: User Defined Field Data - User Guide](#) and [PeopleXD People Management: User Defined Field Configuration - User Guide](#).

My organisation already captures SOC information against the employee contract in PXD People Mgt. using HESA User Types/UDFs (and not standard UDFs) and we intend to use the same field(s) for the 2023/24 return. Do I need to do anything?

Yes. You will need to do the following:

1. If you intend to use the current ACTSOC contract values as the starting-point for a bulk upload into ACTSOC2020, please extract these values via Insight before completing the steps below. You can extract the HESA UDF information directly (using the Insight View – HESA User Data), or alternatively you can extract what was submitted last year (HESA Contract Record 2022).
2. After the HESA release, link your SOC HESA UDFs to the new HESA ACTSOC2020 fields. Your SOC HESA UDFs would have been previously linked to the old ACTSOC fields, but the release will have removed these links. This can be done as follows:
 - a. Navigate to the HESA User Data screen (Back Office application > CoreHR > CoreHESA >15. HESA User Data)
 - b. Select **Field Details** for the applicable HESA User Type
 - c. Update the *HESA Field ID* to the appropriate ACTSOC2020 field (e.g. ACTSOC20201, ACTSOC20202, ACTSOC20203 etc.)
3. Populate the SOC HESA UDF values for all applicable contracts. Given that ACTSOC2020 is a brand-new field, and given the difference between the reference data for ACTSOC and ACTSOC2020, the ACTSOC values previously held against the contract will not transfer across automatically. There are three ways to populate these fields:
 - Employees can populate their own details (if published to the employee)
 - Administrators can update the value for each employee manually
 - Administrators can load a file to bulk update the values for all employees.

Please [refer to the HESA User Guide](#) for more information about managing HESA UDFs, including updating the HESA UDFs against an employee contract.

Given the changes to the SOC coding, my organisation has hundreds of employee contracts which need to be updated to reflect the new coding. What's the best way to do this?

Depending on how/where you store this information in PeopleXD People Management, there may be standard functionality to bulk update PeopleXD Contract information.

See the table below for details:

Field Type	Description
Standard UDF field	Not possible to bulk update
HESA UDF field	Possible to bulk update. Please refer to the HESA User Guide for more information.
Standard Contract fields	Possible to bulk update. Please refer to the Data Migration Update Facility User Guide .

Alternatively, once you have generated the HESA return you can use the PeopleXD HESA *Load Data file* functionality to bulk correct any incorrect SOC values on the HESA Contract record before submitting to HESA. See [Bulk upload corrections in HESA](#) for further details.

However, if you take this approach then please be aware that you are not updating the source of the data (i.e. PeopleXD Contract records), so would need to build this step into your process going forward.



Note: When performing bulk data updates, it's recommended to complete this on a non-production/test environment first to ensure that everything is as expected before doing it on production/live.

I need to extract out SOC information from PeopleXD to assist with a bulk upload. What's the best way to do this?

You can use the following Insight HESA views to extract what was submitted in last year's return.

- Contract Record 2022(HESA)
- Staff Record 2022(HESA)

Alternatively, you can use other views to extract what is held against the employee's record depending on how it is being captured e.g.

- Standard UDFs (Insight View – Person User Data)
- HESA UDFs (Insight View – Hesa User Data)
- Appointment Record (Insight View – Post Person)

My organisation uses a HESA SQL Rule to map SOC information held against the employee contract to the HESA ACTSOC fields (*ACTSOC1*, *ACTSOC2* etc.). How can I update this rule to point to the new *ACTSOC2020* HESA fields?

Assuming the SOC information continues to be held in the same field in PeopleXD People Management, then the release will automatically update the SQL rule so that it populates the new fields.

For example, if you use a SQL Rule to populate *ACTSOC1* based on the value held in a standard UDF, then this rule will be automatically updated to populate *ACTSOC20201* instead.

My organisation references the HESA ACTSOC fields in a HESA SQL rule for another field (i.e. the rule logic checks the HESA ACTSOC fields when working out how to populate the other fields). How can I update this HESA SQL rule to reference the new fields instead?

HESA SQL rules cannot be updated by users via PeopleXD HESA. Amendments to existing rules (or the creation of new rules) must be completed by a TAG PeopleXD Consultant. If you need assistance in this area, please raise an Optimisation Service request via the Customer Success Portal. This is a chargeable service.